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Ukrainian drones shut Moscow's airports

MOSCOW

A sustained Ukrainian drone attack on Russia caused Moscow's major airports to be temporarily closed and saw at least 140 flights cancelled, officials said, according to the BBC.

More than 230 Ukrainian drones were downed over Russia since Saturday morning – including 27 over the capital – according to the Russian defence ministry.

According to Russia's aviation watchdog, the four major airports serving the capital were disrupted and more than 130 flights also had to be redirected. All have since resumed normal operations.

Meanwhile, at least three people were killed during Russian air strikes on Ukraine overnight, according to regional officials.

Russia's Association of Tour Operators (Ator) said yesterday that Moscow airports were closed 10 times in 24 hours due to the strikes. The Kaluga region, southwest of Moscow, was also affected. — Agencies

Dubai property deals hit Dh431b in first half, a 25% jump on 2024

59,075 NEW INVESTORS, INCLUDING RESIDENTS, DRIVE INVESTMENT SURGE

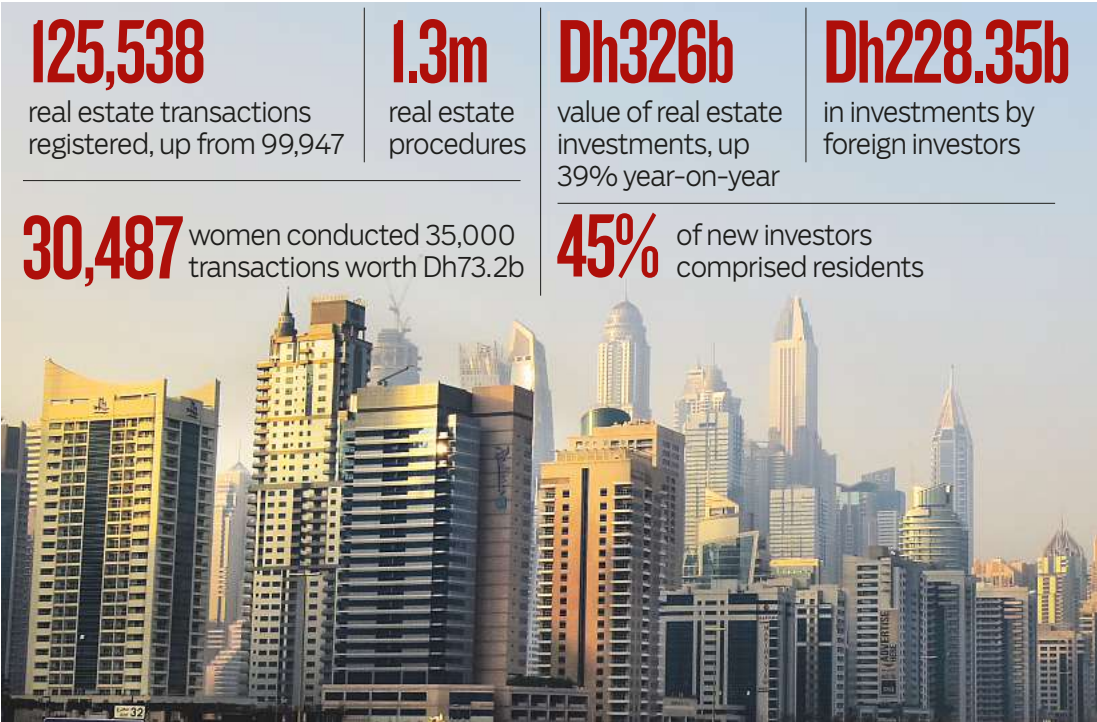
DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

Dubai's real estate market recorded transactions worth over Dh431 billion in the first half of 2025, marking a 25 per cent increase compared to the same period last year, according to new data from the Dubai Land Department (DLD). This milestone reflects the emirate's continued momentum as a global property investment hub.

A total of 125,538 real estate transactions were registered between January and June 2025 – up 26 per cent from 99,947 deals in H1-2024. Overall, real estate procedures (including sales, leases and other formalities) crossed 1.3 million, indicating a strong and growing investor base.

The value of real estate investments hit Dh326 billion, up 39 per cent year-on-year, as nearly 95,000 investors completed over 118,000 transactions in the first six months of the year. Of these, 59,075 were new investors, injecting Dh157 billion into the market – a 40 per cent rise in



value. Notably, residents made up 45 per cent of new investors, highlighting ongoing success in turning tenants into homeowners and boosting long-term market stability.

Female participation saw sig-

nificant growth, with 30,487 women conducting nearly 35,000 transactions worth Dh73.2 billion, reinforcing the increasing role of women in shaping Dubai's property landscape.

By nationality, foreign inves-

tors led with Dh228.35 billion, followed by Arabs (Dh28.4 billion) and GCC nationals (Dh22.56 billion), underlining Dubai's appeal as a cross-border investment destination.

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